SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 19

Buttons, Links & Actions

Complete Guide — Improve User Productivity in Salesforce Lightning

- 🔘 Detail Page Button
- 🔗 Detail Page Link
- 📋 List Button
- ⚡ Quick Actions
- ⚖️ Buttons vs Links vs Actions
- 👀 Visibility Troubleshooting

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL	TOPICS
19 of Series	~19 Minutes	Intermediate	7 Topics

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SECTION 1

Introduction & Recap

⏱ 0:00 – 0:45

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** In the previous episode, we learned about the complete **Sales Process in Salesforce**.

✅ EPISODE 18 RECAP

- The Sales Process in Salesforce manages Leads through Opportunities to closed deals
- Opportunities move through defined stages (Prospecting → Closed Won/Lost)
- Sales processes can be customized per business needs

Today we explore an important **customization feature** that helps users **perform tasks quickly** and boosts productivity — **Buttons, Links & Actions**.

💡 WHY THIS MATTERS

Instead of navigating through multiple pages to perform a task, Buttons, Links & Actions give users **one-click shortcuts** — saving time and improving the overall Salesforce experience.

SECTION 2

📖 What are Buttons, Links & Actions?

⏱ 0:45 – 2:30

🛒 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY — ONLINE SHOPPING

Imagine an online shopping website. You click **Buy Now**, **Add to Cart**, or **Track Order** to perform different actions instantly — without navigating through multiple pages. Salesforce works the **same way**.

📌 DEFINITION

Buttons, Links, and Actions provide shortcuts to perform common tasks inside Salesforce. They save time, improve productivity, and make the application easier to use.

🔘

Buttons

Trigger an operation or action on a record.

e.g., Clone Record, Submit for Approval

🔗

Links

Navigate users to another page or external URL.

e.g., Company Website, Google Maps

⚡

Actions

Create or update records via a quick popup window.

e.g., New Contact, Log a Call

SECTION 3

Detail Page Button

⏱ 2:30 – 5:00

📌 WHAT IS IT?

A Detail Page Button appears on an individual record's detail page. It is used to perform an action related to that specific record.

Common Use Cases:

- Clone a record
- Generate an Invoice (linking to a Visualforce page)
- Submit a record for Approval
- Open a Custom Visualforce Page
- Trigger an external integration or API call

📍 WHERE DOES IT APPEAR?

At the **top of the record page**, in the buttons area when a user opens an individual record.

💻 Demo — How to Create a Detail Page Button

1. Go to ⚙️ **Setup** → `Object Manager`
2. Select the Object (e.g., `Account`)
3. Click `Buttons, Links, and Actions` from the left sidebar
4. Click `New Button or Link`
5. Choose **Display Type:** `Detail Page Button`
6. Fill in the Label, Name, and Behavior (e.g., URL or Visualforce page)
7. Click `Save`

8. Go to `Page Layouts` → edit the layout → drag the new button into the **Custom Buttons** section → Save

9. Open an Account record to verify the button appears

> 💡 **IMPORTANT**
>
> After creating a button, you **must add it to the Page Layout** — otherwise it won't be visible to users!

SECTION 4

Detail Page Link

⏱ 5:00 – 7:00

📌 WHAT IS IT?

A Detail Page Link also appears on an individual record page. Unlike a button, it is primarily used for navigation — redirecting users to another page or an external website.

🧭 THINK OF IT AS...

A shortcut hyperlink that opens a related resource. Instead of searching for the company's website separately, a **Detail Page Link** puts it right on the record page.

Common Use Cases:

- Open the Company Website (from an Account record)
- Open Google Maps with the customer's address pre-filled
- Link to Internal Documentation or wikis
- Open a Customer Portal link
- Navigate to a related Salesforce record or report

Feature	🔘 Detail Page Button	🔗 Detail Page Link
Primary Purpose	Perform an operation/action	Navigate to a page or URL
Appears On	Individual record page (button area)	Individual record page (links section)
Example	Clone Record, Submit for Approval	Open Company Website, Google Maps
Visual Style	Displayed as a clickable button	Displayed as a hyperlink

💻 Demo — How to Create a Detail Page Link

1. Go to `Object Manager` → select the Object → `Buttons, Links, and Actions`
2. Click `New Button or Link`
3. Choose **Display Type:** `Detail Page Link`

4. Enter Label, Name, and the URL (can use field merge values like `{!Account.Website}`)
5. Click `Save`
6. Add the link to the **Page Layout** under the Custom Links section → Save
7. Open a record and click the link to verify it redirects correctly

SECTION 5

📋 List Button

⏱ 7:00 – 9:30

📌 WHAT IS IT?

A List Button appears in **List Views** or **Related Lists** — when viewing multiple records at once. It is designed to perform operations on **one or more records simultaneously**.

🗂️ KEY DIFFERENCE FROM DETAIL PAGE BUTTON

A **Detail Page Button** works on a *single record*. A **List Button** works when you're looking at *multiple records* in a list and may apply to selected records in bulk.

Common Use Cases:

- Export selected records to a spreadsheet
- Mass Update multiple records at once
- Add multiple records to a campaign
- Send a List Email to selected contacts
- Trigger a bulk action or integration

📍 WHERE DOES IT APPEAR?

In the **List View toolbar** at the top of a list, or in the **Related List** section on a record page.

💻 Demo — How to Create a List Button

1. Go to `Object Manager` → select the Object → `Buttons, Links, and Actions`
2. Click `New Button or Link`
3. Choose **Display Type:** `List Button`
4. Fill in the Label, Name, and the action behavior
5. Click `Save`

6 Add the button to the **related list** settings in the Page Layout

7 Open a List View and observe where the button appears

SECTION 6

Quick Actions

⏱ 9:30 – 13:00

📌 WHAT IS IT?

Quick Actions allow users to **create or update records quickly** through a small popup window — without navigating away from the current page. This saves time and improves the user experience.

There are **two types** of Quick Actions:

🎯

Object-Specific Actions

Belong to a **specific object** and are only available when viewing records of that object. They have a **predefined relationship** to the parent record.

On an Account Record:

Create Contact | Create Opportunity | Log a Call | Send Email

🌐

Global Actions

Not tied to any specific object. Available from **anywhere** in Salesforce (e.g., from the navigation bar). Records created won't have an automatic relationship to a parent.

Available Everywhere:

Create Task | Create Event | Log a Call | New Contact

Feature	🎯 Object-Specific Actions	🌐 Global Actions
Where Available?	Only on a specific object's record page	Anywhere in Salesforce
Record Relationship	Auto-linked to parent record	No automatic relationship
Created From	Object Manager → [Object] → Buttons, Links & Actions	Setup → Global Actions
Added To	Object's Page Layout	Global Publisher Layouts

💻 Demo — How to Create Quick Actions

Object-Specific Action:

1. Go to `Object Manager` → Select Object (e.g., Account) → `Buttons, Links, and Actions`

2. Click `New Action`
3. Choose **Action Type** (e.g., `Create a Record`, `Update a Record`, `Log a Call`)
4. Fill in Label, Name, and Target Object → `Save`
5. Add to the Page Layout → **Salesforce Mobile & Lightning Experience Actions** section

Global Action:

1. In Setup, search for `Global Actions`
2. Click `New Action` → Choose Action Type → Fill in details → `Save`
3. Go to `Publisher Layouts` → add the action → `Save`
4. Test it from the **navigation bar** or any record page in Lightning Experience

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SECTION 7

Buttons vs Links vs Actions

⏱ 13:00 – 14:30

Feature	🔘 Button	🔗 Link	⚡ Action
Primary Use	Perform an operation	Navigate to a URL/page	Create or update records
UI Style	Clickable button	Hyperlink	Popup/modal window
Examples	Clone, Submit for Approval, Generate Invoice	Company Website, Google Maps, Documentation	New Contact, Log a Call, Send Email
Scope	Single or multiple records	Single record (navigation)	Single record popup
Stays on same page?	Depends on behavior set	Navigates away	Yes — popup overlay

🧠 EASY MEMORY TRICK

🔘 **Buttons** → *DO something* (take action on record) | 🔗 **Links** → *GO somewhere* (navigate) | ⚡ **Actions** → *CREATE or UPDATE quickly* (without leaving the page)

SECTION 8 — TROUBLESHOOTING

Why Are My Buttons or Actions Not Visible?

⏱ 14:30 – 18:00

This is one of the most **frequently asked questions** by Salesforce beginners. Here are all the reasons and how to fix them:

1 Not Added to Page Layout

Creating a Button, Link, or Action is only the first step. You must also **add it to the Page Layout**. Go to **Object Manager** → **Page Layouts** → **Edit** and drag it into the correct section (Custom Buttons or Actions).

Most Common Reason

2 Salesforce Mobile & Lightning Experience Actions Section

In the Page Layout, scroll to the **"Salesforce Mobile & Lightning Experience Actions"** section. If you've added *any* custom action here, Salesforce will **only show those** — the default actions are replaced. If you haven't customized this section, Salesforce shows its default actions automatically.

Very Common

3 Lightning Record Page Configuration

The **Lightning Record Page** (built in App Builder) controls what components appear. Even if a button is in the Page Layout, the Lightning Record Page configuration can override or restrict its visibility. Always check the page assignment and component settings in **App Builder**.

Check App Builder

4 Dynamic Forms (Common Misconception)

Many beginners think **Dynamic Forms** control Buttons and Links — but that's **NOT true**. Dynamic Forms only control *Fields* and *Field Sections* on a Lightning Record Page. However, Quick Actions shown in the **Highlights Panel** may be affected by how the Lightning Record Page is configured.

Common Misconception

5 Highlights Panel Configuration

The **Highlights Panel** at the top of a record page displays key information and commonly used actions. If your Quick Action isn't visible, check whether it's configured to appear in the **Highlights Panel** component in App Builder.

Check Highlights Panel

6 Dynamic Actions (Advanced — Optional)

In Lightning Experience, **Dynamic Actions** allow you to control *when* an action appears based on conditions:

- Record Type (only show for specific record types)
- Field Values (show only when a field has a certain value)
- User Profile (show only for specific user profiles)
- Custom Visibility Rules

This provides a more **personalized and context-aware** user experience.

Advanced Feature

⚠️ QUICK CHECKLIST — IF BUTTON/ACTION IS MISSING

- Is it added to the **Page Layout**?
- Is the **Salesforce Mobile & Lightning Experience Actions** section customized?
- Is the **Lightning Record Page** correctly configured and assigned?
- Is the user's **Profile** assigned to the correct Page Layout?
- Are **Dynamic Actions** filtering it out based on conditions?

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 19

01

Buttons, Links & Actions are productivity shortcuts in Salesforce that help users perform tasks without navigating through multiple pages.

02

A **Detail Page Button** performs operations on a single record. A **List Button** works across multiple records in a list view.

03

A **Detail Page Link** is for navigation (opening URLs). **Quick Actions** open a popup to create or update records without leaving the page.

04

Object-Specific Actions are tied to one object and auto-link to the parent record. **Global Actions** are available everywhere in Salesforce.

05

After creating any Button, Link, or Action, you **must add it to the Page Layout** — otherwise it won't be visible to users.

06

Dynamic Actions allow conditional visibility of actions based on Record Type, Field Values, User Profile, and custom rules — for a personalized experience.



COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 20

Next Important Salesforce Admin Feature

Continue exploring powerful Salesforce Admin customization features in the next lesson.

These notes are a companion to the YouTube video. Watch the full demo for hands-on guidance.